

Sports

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Looking ahead to
TOMORROW
IN MASTERS, PART II: See
who moves up (or down)
in the second round of The
Masters golf tournament.

Friday, April 11, 2008



Phil Mickelson waits to hit a chip shot on the 13th hole during the first round of the 2008 Masters at the Augusta National Golf Club in Augusta, Ga., on Thursday. Mickelson battled in and out of trouble to finish with a 1-under-par 71, three strokes behind the leaders.

A game of pitch, catch

Tigers' battery sailing along

By DREW BRUNO

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Take a guess at Memorial's battery for Thursday's high school baseball game with Boone, and if the answer is Dean Stuckey pitching and Carl Morales behind the plate, well, you're either good or just playing the odds.

It was Stuckey's second start of the season but he said he's been in every game but one in relief as the Figure No. 1 starter for the third season in a

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Passing camp returns

By RANDY BEARD

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A touch of high school spring football returns to Evansville next week in the form of a skills camp for quarterbacks, receivers and defensive backs.

For four consecutive Tuesdays through May 6, North High School coach Mike Wilson and other area coaches will conduct sessions of the Scheib Football Skills Camp at the Goebel Soccer Complex.

It is only the second time in SOS Camp has been conducted in

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IF YOU GO

What: Scheib O'Hara Scheib Football Skills Camp for quarterbacks, receivers and defensive backs for players in sixth through 11th grades.

When: Tuesday nights, 7:30 p.m. to 9 p.m., Goebel Soccer Complex, April 15, April 22, April 29 and May 6. The fee is \$120 for all four sessions or \$30 per session. For more information, go to www.scheibfootballcamp.com.

Young English star shares lead

Rose blooming again

By PAUL NEWBERRY

Associated Press sports writer

Augusta, Ga. — Justin Rose has the first round of the Masters down pat. It's the rest of the tournament he must master. Rose shot a 4-under 68 that put him atop the leaderboard on a sunny opening day that featured Ian Poulter's hole-in-one, a solid start to Zach Johnson's title defense and Tiger Woods poised for a run at another green jacket. Sound familiar?

In 2004, the Englishman led after the first and second rounds but faded to a tie for 22nd. Returning to Augusta National a year ago, Rose surged to the front again with a 69 in the opening round, but didn't come close to matching that score the rest of the weekend, settling for a fifth-place tie three strokes behind Johnson.

On Thursday, he got off to another quick start and was tied for the lead with South African Trevor Immelman.

"I've learned you can't count your chickens too early," said Rose, who won the Order of Merit as the top golfer on the European Tour in 2007. "Obviously, the first round has been great to me here."

Woods prefers to do his best work on

THE MASTERS FIRST-ROUND LEADERS

(Top 10)

Justin Rose	34-34-68
Trevor Immelman	34-34-68
Brian Bateman	35-34-69
Brandt Snedeker	35-34-69
Lee Westwood	35-34-69
Ian Poulter	35-35-70
Robert Karlsson	36-34-70
Zach Johnson	35-35-70
Stephen Ames	34-36-70
Jim Furyk	34-36-70

the weekend. In his four previous Augusta wins, he twice trailed by three shots after the first round, another time by five, and was a daunting seven shots back in 2005.

Woods, who shot a 72, remained the favorite to win his fifth green jacket — the starting point for an unprecedented Grand Slam. "I feel good about how I played all day," he said. "I hit a lot of good putts that just didn't go in. I've just got to stay patient

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Justin Rose of England reacts after making par on the 18th hole to maintain a share of the lead at the Masters.

Evansville's Spoelstra experienced it all

When the NBA was a long ride and a poor paycheck

By GARRET MATHEWS

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Art Spoelstra never made more than \$5,500 in an NBA career that began in 1954 with the Rochester Royals and ended when his knees gave out 17 games into the 1957-58 season with the New York Knicks.

"The team flew into Fort Wayne one night in a snowstorm," his son Neal recalled on Thursday. "There were no calls and no buses. They didn't coddle the players back then like they do now. You had a game the next night hundreds of miles away and it was your job to be at the gym on time. One of the players' brothers ended up piloting all the players in his car and taking them to the arena."

Irene, his fourth wife, met the 6-foot-9 professional basketball player at a bar in New York City. "I had brothers who were tall and I always wanted a tall man," she said. "We started talking and I liked what he had to say. I asked him to marry me that first night. I was 35. He was 40. Why waste time?"

Art Spoelstra died Wednesday after bouts with heart trouble, ulcers and peritonitis. The Evansville man was 75.

The native of Grand Rapids, Mich., played at Western Kentucky University and was drafted in the fourth round by the Royals. Usually a bench player, his best season was the 1955-56 campaign when he averaged 8.5 points.

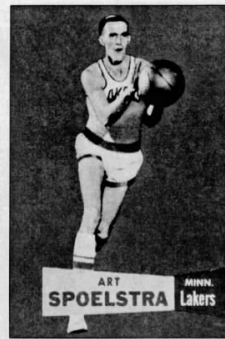
"After Art quit playing, he got in the insurance business,"

Irene Spoelstra said, "but the white-collar world wasn't for him. He became a stagehand in New York, joined the union and worked a number of Broadway plays. He was good at it and got to know actors like Art Carney and Kevin Kline."

The 70-year-old woman, a New York native, said her late husband was "a hard-headed Dutchman who had a temper. He could definitely tell you to stuff it in your hat, but he was also very gregarious. If he was your friend, he would do anything in the world for you. He loved dogs. If one died, he was inconsolable."

She laughed. "That man could party. He loved to have a good time. Art was also very competitive at any-

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An Art Spoelstra basketball card from when he was with the Minnesota Lakers.

Pacers still have a shot

By CLIFF BRUNT

AP Sports Writer

INDIANAPOLIS — For a few moments, Indiana Pacers coach Jim O'Brien imagined an entire season with his current rotation.

He thought about Danny Granger and Mike Dunleavy, who are having career years and both averaging 19 points per game. He considered Troy Murphy, a forward who is averaging 15 points and nine rebounds the past 11 games. He's pleased with rebounding

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